

Night Watch

Five helpers work your question while you sleep.
You wake up and check their homework.

Each helper works alone all night, in its own room, and never sees what the others wrote. In the morning you put all five piles on the table together for the first time, cross out what does not hold up, and write down what is still missing. Then the next night starts from what is missing.

FILL THIS IN BEFORE BED

YOUR NAME

TONIGHT'S DATE

LOOP NUMBER

THREE THINGS TO KNOW BEFORE YOU START



The night does the gathering.

Five helpers, five rounds, all while you sleep. That part runs on its own and needs nobody watching.



The morning does the deciding.

Fifteen minutes with a cup of coffee. This is the part that makes the night worth anything.



Never let one helper read another.

If they can see each other's work you no longer have five opinions. You have one opinion copied five times.

00 **What happens overnight**

READ ME FIRST

You go to bed with a question and a few possible answers. A helper called Dispatch stays up and does the work.

Dispatch asks helper 1 your question, writes the reply into a file, and closes it. Then helper 2, in a brand new conversation that knows nothing about helper 1. Then 3, 4 and 5. That is one round. Then it does the whole thing again with a different way of looking at the question. Five rounds in all, so twenty-five separate conversations, none of which know the others exist.

Nothing gets decided during the night. Nothing gets crossed out, nothing gets agreed. The night only collects.

In the morning you open all twenty-five files, put the claims side by side, check the ones that can be checked, cross out the answers that failed, and list what is still unknown. That list becomes tonight's question.

A REAL EXAMPLE

Your question	Should we price the service monthly or per project?
Possible answers	A) monthly. B) per project. C) monthly with a setup fee.
Overnight	Five helpers each write claims about all three, five times over, never seeing each other.
Morning	Two helpers claim monthly billing needs a 6-month contract to break even. You check the maths. It holds. Answer A is crossed out.
Tonight	The new question is the biggest thing nobody could settle -- say, what a setup fee does to sign-ups.



Why bother with five, and why blind?

Ask one helper and you get one opinion. Ask five who can see each other and the loudest one drags the rest along, so you still have one opinion. Keep them apart and disagreement means something: it shows you exactly where the question is genuinely hard.

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

What is in this booklet

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This uses your normal subscriptions, not developer keys

That is what keeps the cost down. It also means a computer is driving accounts meant for a person. Some companies allow that and some do not, and the rules differ for each of the five. Read what each one says before the first unattended night, not after something goes wrong.

01 **The one rule**

MOST IMPORTANT PAGE

Two people who peek at each other's homework stop being two people. Everything in this booklet exists to stop that happening.

**Nobody sees anybody**

Every helper gets a brand new, empty conversation for every round. No helper is ever shown another helper's words, another helper's name, or even told that other helpers exist. No helper is told which answers have already been crossed out or what is on the missing list. All of that waits until every round is finished and the files are in your hands.

Three ways this breaks by accident, none of which look like mistakes afterwards:

**Using the same chat window twice.**

The helper scrolls up and reads what it said last round. It is now arguing with itself instead of thinking fresh. Always a new conversation.

**Pasting round 2's findings into round 3.**

It feels helpful. It turns five independent opinions into one opinion with four echoes.

**Letting Dispatch summarise what the others found.**

Same problem wearing a nicer coat. A summary is still the others' work.

**Why this is worth being strict about**

If the isolation leaks, the helpers start agreeing. Agreement feels like proof. So a leaked night does not look like a failed night -- it looks like your best night ever, and you cannot tell the difference from reading the files. That is why the rule has no exceptions rather than a judgement call.

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

02 Before bed

TEN MINUTES

☐ Write your question as one sentence.

If it takes a paragraph, it is more than one question. Split it and run the other one tomorrow.

TONIGHT'S QUESTION

☐ Write down what would prove an answer **WRONG**.

This is the important one. If you cannot say what would knock an answer down, the helpers cannot knock it down either, and you will wake up to five essays instead of a decision.

WHAT WOULD DISPROVE IT

☐ Write two to four possible answers.

They can be rough. They can even be ones you think are wrong -- wrong ones are useful, because crossing them out is progress. One answer on its own is not a choice, it is a hope.

A

B

C

☐ Open all five helpers and check each one replies.

Send each a quick hello by hand. A helper that has quietly logged you out at 2am costs you the whole night.

1

2

3

4

5

☐ Set a hard stopping time.

Two full loops is plenty. The third almost never adds anything the second did not. Without a limit, a loop set to accept everything just keeps going.

MAX LOOPS

STOP AT (TIME)

☐ Make tonight's folder, one file per helper per round.

Twenty-five files. Written once, never edited. This is your proof in the morning that nobody peeked.

```
nw-001/
round-1/ helper-1.md ... helper-5.md
round-2/ helper-1.md ... helper-5.md
... rounds 3, 4, 5 ...
missing.md answers.md ledger.md
```

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

03 The five rounds

WHILE YOU SLEEP

Every round asks the same question through a different lens. Finish a whole round with all five helpers before starting the next one.

ROUND	THE LENS	WHAT YOU ARE ASKING FOR, IN PLAIN WORDS
1	Turn it upside down	Pretend each answer is wrong. What would have to be true for it to be wrong? This is the round that crosses things out.
2	How could it break	If we picked this answer, what goes wrong later, and would we even notice in time?
3	Could we build it	Is this answer something we could actually do and actually test, or does it only sound good?
4	What are we not seeing	Knock-on effects, contradictions, and what the question itself leaves out.
5	What would change your mind	What evidence would move you, and how much? Say your starting assumptions out loud.

☐

Round 1 finished -- Turn it upside down

Tick only when all five helpers have written their file.

HELPERS DONE

ANYTHING CROSSED OUT?

☐

Round 2 finished -- How could it break

Tick only when all five helpers have written their file.

HELPERS DONE

ANYTHING CROSSED OUT?

☐

Round 3 finished -- Could we build it

Tick only when all five helpers have written their file.

HELPERS DONE

ANYTHING CROSSED OUT?

☐

Round 4 finished -- What are we not seeing

Tick only when all five helpers have written their file.

HELPERS DONE

ANYTHING CROSSED OUT?

☐

Round 5 finished -- What would change your mind

Tick only when all five helpers have written their file.

HELPERS DONE

ANYTHING CROSSED OUT?

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

04 What to say to each helper

COPY THIS EXACTLY

Send the same words to all five. Only the round name changes. If you word it differently for different helpers, you end up measuring your typing rather than their thinking.

THE MESSAGE -- FILL IN THE ANGLE BRACKETS

You are one of several reviewers working separately. You will not see anyone else's work and they will not see yours. Do not guess what anyone else might say.

THE QUESTION

<your one sentence>

THE POSSIBLE ANSWERS

A: <...> B: <...> C: <...>

YOUR LENS FOR THIS ROUND: <round name from page 6>

Reply with exactly these three headings and nothing else.

CLAIMS - numbered. For each one write the statement, then say how it could be checked: a sum, a source, a command to run, or say plainly that it is a judgement call with no way to check it. Saying 'this is a judgement call' is a good answer, not a failure.

BEARING - for each possible answer, which of your claims would knock it down if the claim turned out to be true, and why.

MISSING - what you could not work out, and what would settle it.

Do not rank the answers. Do not pick a winner.



Why the helper is told not to pick a winner

The answer is whatever is still standing at the end, not whatever scored highest. A helper that picks a favourite is voting -- and five votes from five AIs that were trained on much the same internet is one vote counted five times. Claims can be checked. Favourites cannot.

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

05 Morning: cross out and list

THE DECIDING PART

This is the first moment the five piles meet each other.

☐**Group the claims by what they say, not how they say it.**

Two helpers saying the same thing in different words is agreement. The same words about different things is not. Match on the checkable part.

☐**Check every claim that can be checked.**

Sums get added up. Sources get opened -- actually opened, in a browser. Commands get run. Never accept a claim because a helper sounded sure.

CLAIMS CHECKED

CLAIMS THAT FAILED

☐**Cross out any answer whose claim failed.**

Only crossing out. If two answers are still standing, write down two. Picking between them with a coin, a gut feeling, or a vote is exactly what this whole method exists to avoid.

CROSSED OUT

STILL STANDING

☐**Write the missing list.**

Every judgement call, every MISSING line, every source you could not open. Next to each one, write what would settle it. A missing item you cannot act on is just a disclaimer.

HOW MANY MISSING

☐**Pick tonight's question: the biggest thing on the missing list.**

Not the same question again. The loop earns its keep by narrowing. If a whole night produced nothing new, stop -- it has given you what it has.

TONIGHT'S QUESTION

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

06 Morning: check the work

ONLY YOU CAN DO THIS

**Why a person has to do this bit**

When this was measured properly, having something check the work in the middle cut mistakes by about four times. Letting helpers run in parallel with nothing checking them corrected no mistakes at all -- it simply produced more confident wrong answers. The night is the cheap half. This is the half that makes the night mean something.

**Open two helpers' files from the same round and compare them.**

If they share an unusual phrase, the same structure, or the same odd example, the wall between them leaked. Throw the loop away. A leaked loop is worse than no loop, because it reads as agreement.

WALL HELD? YES/NO

**If all five agreed almost exactly, be suspicious, not pleased.**

Five people thinking for themselves about a hard question do not write the same list. If they did, they most likely share the same blind spot -- so your five helpers are really worth about one.

UNUSUAL AGREEMENT?

**Open every source with your own eyes.**

Five helpers agreeing a source exists is five helpers agreeing. It is not a source. Nothing here checks that, and a made-up reference looks exactly like a real one.

**Make sure a helper that failed is written down as FAILED.**

Not as 'found nothing'. Those are opposite facts. A helper that never answered has told you nothing; a helper that answered and found nothing has told you something.

HELPERS THAT FAILED

**Write the deliverable from what survived AND what is missing.**

Both, in the same document. An answer with an open missing list is a front-runner, not a conclusion. Send both or send neither.

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

07 Rules for Dispatch

PASTE INTO THE INSTRUCTIONS

Give these to Dispatch word for word before the first night.

☐ Never show one helper another helper's words, name, or existence.

☐ Always start a brand new conversation. Never reuse one.

☐ Never edit a file after writing it. Write a new one instead.

The files are the proof. An edited file proves nothing.

☐ Never ask a helper whether a source is real.

☐ Never tick anything off the missing list. Only the morning does that.

☐ Never touch passwords, payment details, or account settings.

☐ If a helper fails: write it down, carry on with the others, and do not keep retrying.

Retrying over and over turns one failure into a whole night of them.

☐ Stop at the loop limit even if it looks unfinished.

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong

08 Night ledger

FILL IN AT BREAKFAST

LAST NIGHT

LOOPS THAT RAN

CONVERSATIONS IN TOTAL

HELPERS THAT FAILED

CLAIMS COLLECTED

ANSWERS CROSSED OUT

ANSWERS STILL STANDING

THINGS STILL MISSING

DID THE WALL HOLD?



Tonight's question is written down and the folder is ready.

TONIGHT'S QUESTION

SIGNED



What a good night looks like

A few answers crossed out for reasons you can point at. A short, honest missing list. Helpers that disagreed in interesting places. That is a good night. Five helpers agreeing on everything with nothing missing is not a good night -- it is a night where something went wrong and nobody caught it.

NOTES — anything you noticed, anything that felt wrong